

ER OON Operating Model 2027

We meet the January 1 Gateway deadline without disruption, give every account one owner from coding to payment, and build a workforce that grows by skill. We start on the proven model and earn the automated one in stages.

● Hard deadline: the IDR Gateway becomes US-only on January 1, 2027

10

full-cycle teams replace 12 facility teams

94

people in Lebanon; no layoffs, no pay cuts

12 → 31

facilities absorbed in two years without new teams

9

skill badges drive levels, pay and routing

\$409–499K

yearly saving by year two if Model B passes its gates

WHY NOW

Three pressures arrive together

Each one alone would justify change. Together they make the current facility-based structure untenable.

Jan 1

The Gateway goes US-only

Our negotiators spend 50–70% of their time in it today. From January 1, only US-based staff may use it.

5×

Workload is uneven

Open claims per person range from 138 to 704 across facility teams. Effort, not geography, should set the load.

+19

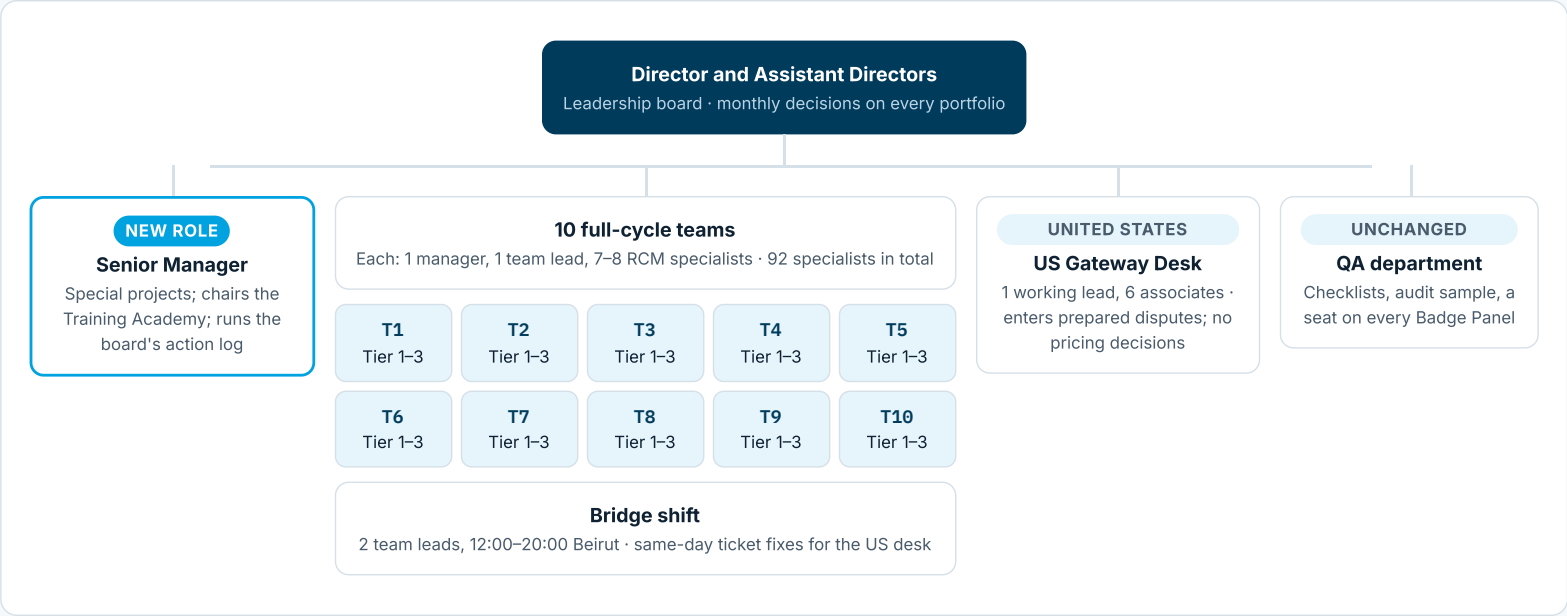
We are growing fast

We go from 12 to 31 facilities in two years. The model must absorb them without adding a team for each one.

THE STRUCTURE

One owner per account, ten balanced teams, a US desk for the Gateway

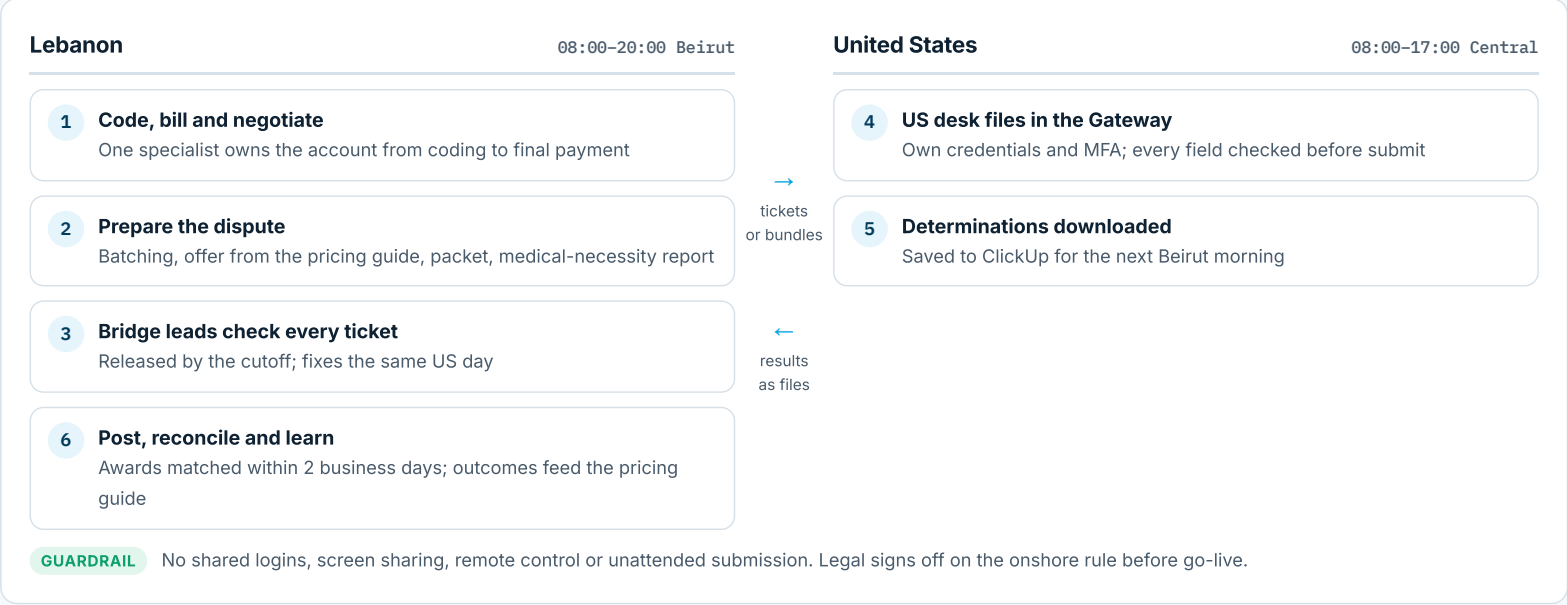
Teams own payer portfolios, not facilities. Lebanon prepares every dispute and keeps every pricing decision; the US desk only enters the work into the Gateway.



HOW WORK MOVES

Lebanon prepares, the US files, results return overnight

Only prepared files cross the boundary. No one outside the US ever sees or operates a Gateway session.



Model A secures January 1; Model B lowers the cost once it is proven

Both models share the same ten teams, levels and pay bands. They differ in how Gateway filing is done. Recruiting is in-house and both run on systems we already own.

Model A · People-first

7

US desk staff

~47 min

filing time per dispute

\$346–421K

US desk per year today

GO-LIVE MODEL

- Ready on January 1 with no new software · ClickUp tickets and the deadline engine
- A larger desk absorbs absences and volume spikes
- Highest running cost · grows to \$861K–1.05M by year two

Model B · Automation-first

3

US desk staff

~10 min

target filing time

\$206–261K

US desk and AI per year today

EARNED IN STAGES

- Lebanon sends ready-to-file bundles · a Submission Cockpit replaces typing
- AI drafts packets and reports; specialists approve every one
- Depends on Gateway terms and a 3-person desk · one absence is a third of capacity

Annual US desk cost, Model A against Model B

Year	Model A (Midpoint)	Model A Range	Model B (Midpoint)	Model B Range	Savings
Today	\$346K	\$346K–421K	\$206K	\$206K–261K	\$140–160K saved a year with B
Year 1	\$580K	\$580K–707K	\$331K	\$331K–408K	\$249–299K saved a year with B
Year 2	\$861K	\$861K–1050K	\$452K	\$452K–551K	\$409–499K saved a year with B

Legend: Grey bar = Model A, midpoint; Blue bar = Model B, midpoint. Whiskers show the low-high range. USD thousands · direct hire plus 25% benefits and taxes.

QUESTION	MODEL A	MODEL B	EDGE
Ready for January 1?	Yes	Runs on Model A's desk until Gate 2, April 30	A
Outside approvals needed	Legal sign-off on the onshore rule	Also written confirmation the Gateway allows assisted filing	A
Resilience to absence	1 of 7 people	1 of 3 people	A
US hours covered	One US day shift	12 hours, three staggered shifts	B
Lebanon hiring by year two	About 125 specialists	About 102, with AI drafting	B
Cost by year two	\$861K–1.05M	\$452–551K	B

PEOPLE AND CAREERS

One role, four levels, earned by skill

Former titles no longer set pay or work. Nine badges certify what each specialist can do alone, control what ClickUp routes to them, and open the next level. Pay bands are USD per month.

L1

RCM Specialist I

\$1,000–1,300

Earning the 5 core badges · Tier 3 portfolio

L2

RCM Specialist II

\$1,200–1,550

All 5 core badges · full-cycle account owner

L3

Senior Specialist

\$1,400–1,800

Core + 2 advanced; top 40% Net Recovery · Tier 1

L4

Principal

\$1,600–2,000

Core + 3 advanced; top 20%; teaches in the Academy

The nine badges

C1
Claim follow-up

C2
Open Negotiation

C3
NNSA appeal

C4
Payment posting

C5
Medical-necessity report

A1
Coding (certified)

A2
IDR packet and offer

A3
MVA negotiation

A4
Payer strategy

Leadership ladder:

L3 + coaching assessment → **Team Lead** \$1,400–2,000

12 months as TL, or L4 + training → **Manager** \$2,000–3,000

About 14 team lead and 7 manager seats open as we grow.

TRAINING ACADEMY

A new hire becomes a full account owner in six months

Training happens on live work: about 20% classroom, 80% supervised production checked by a badge-holder. A committee awards badges and recommends promotions; no one decides alone on their own team.

The Academy Committee

1Chair and owner
A manager, preferably the Senior Manager

2–3Managers
From different teams; 12-month staggered terms

2+2L4 Principals and L3 Seniors
Lead trainers and assessors

2Team leads, rotating
New pair each quarter; 8 serve every year

1QA reviewer
Scores quality; sits on every Badge Panel

From day one to L2

Weeks 1–2 Onboarding HIPAA, systems, NSA	Months 1–2 C1 + C4 Follow-up, posting	Month 3 C5 Medical necessity
Months 4–5 C2 Open Negotiation	Month 6 C3 NNSA appeal	Next quarter L2 Account owner
100% core badges held by June 30, 2027	2+ holders of every badge in every team	≤10 days from assessment request to result

LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIOS

Every manager owns one area the model depends on

Eleven portfolios, one per manager and the Senior Manager. Owners are assigned by the leadership board. Dashed tiles are additions the model needs to succeed.

Training Academy Onboard, train, award, promote Core badges for all by June 30, 2027	Payments and Reconciliation Every dollar posted and reconciled IDR awards matched in 2 business days	Onshore-Offshore Liaison One channel: Lebanon, US desk, accounting 98% same-day completion	External Relations IDR entities and payers 80% of escalations resolved in 30 days
Automation, ClickUp, AI and Data Tools and one source of numbers Dashboards ready by the 3rd business day	Coding Quality Guidelines and E/M level ratios 95% coding audit accuracy	Denials and NNSA Strategy Patterns, appeals, letter library Denial rate down every quarter	IDR Performance Results by location, payer, entity Win rate and recovery after fees
Compliance and Deadlines Deadlines, HIPAA, Gateway access Zero missed regulatory deadlines	Pricing Guide Offers, settlements, decision rights 100% inside the guide or approved	Capacity and Growth Workload balance, 19 new facilities Teams within 90-110% of target	How they report Findings and recommendations, every month One template, one set of numbers
Monthly report To the director and assistant directors by the 5th business day	Monthly leadership board Each owner presents findings; the board decides	Quarterly deep-dive Every portfolio reviewed in depth once a quarter	Yearly review Targets reset; owners confirmed or rotated

ROADMAP

The Gateway first, the structure second, automation when it is proven

The cutover happens on December 19, two weeks before the deadline. Team structure changes only after the Gateway is stable, so any problem has one cause.

Oct 2026 Prepare Legal sign-off; hire the US desk; Academy set up	Nov 2026 Build and train Ticket workflow and deadline engine live by Nov 21	Dec 2026 Parallel run 25%, 50%, then all Gateway work	Jan-Feb 2027 Launch 10 teams Fast-track badges; provisional levels; Cockpit pilot	Mar-Jun 2027 Cross-train Everyone earns the 5 core badges; Model B steps down	Jul 2027-2028 Full cycle and growth Advanced badges; 19 facilities join existing teams	
◆ Nov 30 Gate 0 Legal and Gateway terms say yes to Model B	◆ Dec 19 Full cutover Same-day completion; 98% first-pass tickets	◆ Jan 1, 2027 Gateway US-only Hard regulatory deadline	◆ Mar 15 Gate 1 ≤12 min per dispute; errors under 0.5%	◆ Apr 30 Gate 2 4 weeks on a 3-person desk, backlog under a day	◆ Jun 30 Levels confirmed Core badges earned; provisional levels final	◆ Jan 2028 Retention paid out Critical staff retained through the change

Blue gates belong to Model B. If any Model B gate fails, we stay on Model A at no extra cost.

RISKS WE ARE MANAGING

Every major risk has an owner and a fallback

We misread the Gateway's onshore rule

HIGH IMPACT

Legal sign-off before the build; offshore access stays as a fallback until December 19.

The US desk falls behind as volume grows

MEDIUM

A backlog trigger adds staff within 2 weeks; bridge leads report it daily.

People read new levels as a demotion

MEDIUM

Provisional levels, protected pay, published criteria and one appeal each.

We lose IDR experts during the change

HIGH IMPACT

Retention bonus through January 2028 and an L4 path that does not require managing.

Model B's small desk or tools fail

MODEL B

Kill switches return us to Model A staffing; manual entry always stays available.

DECISIONS REQUESTED TODAY

Six approvals to start in October

- 1

Approve the US Gateway Desk
1 working lead and 6 associates, hired in-house from October
- 2

Approve the 10 full-cycle teams
Launch in January–February 2027, after the Gateway cutover
- 3

Approve the role, badges and pay bands
Including the bridge shift incentive, up to \$6,000 a year
- 4

Create the Senior Manager role and the portfolios
Senior Manager in place before the Academy set-up
- 5

Approve Model B's Gate 0 review and Cockpit pilot
Step down to 3 US staff only after Gates 1 and 2 pass
- 6

Confirm the no-layoff commitment
No one's pay goes down; levels provisional until June 30, 2027

Sources: ER OON Operating Model 2027 executive summary; Model A vs Model B comparison; RCM Specialist Badge Competency Matrix; Training Academy curriculum; Manager portfolios appendix.

US cost figures are approximate Texas market rates for direct hires, not quotes. Recruiting is in-house and infrastructure is already in place, so neither is included.